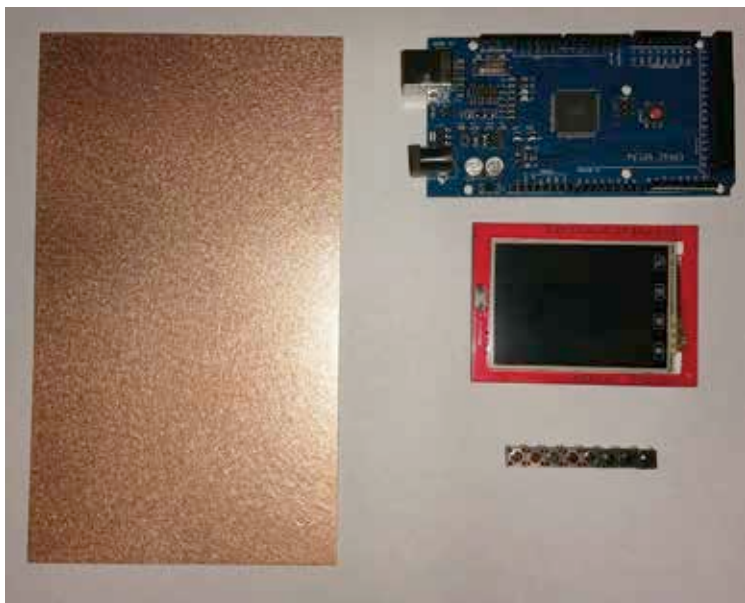


7. Etching

After the important part, we come to the dangerous part. This portion of your work involves muriatic acid which is dangerous. Hence, use enough protection. **It is important for you to use your gloves and goggles.** Use a mask to protect your breathing organs. Protect your skin, too with properly covered clothes. Do not do this in garments that you don't want to be ruined. Also, use your garage or basement or some outdoor place to do this bit.



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With that out of the way, we can focus clearly on the preparations of etching. Remember your containers? Put together three of them. One will contain the etching solution, another will be used to store hydrogen peroxide, and the remaining one will be for the safe disposal of these components. You will use hydrogen peroxide to rinse your board after etching is done.

To prepare your etching solution, add muriatic acid and hydrogen peroxide in a 1:2 ratio. Use your measuring cup to do this properly.

Your copper board must be free of any traces of paper. Only your circuit should be present on it. Now, place the board into the etching solution.

Do this gently and you will see that the solution changes color due to the reaction of an acid with copper. Move the container gently to ensure that